Chopped Blue Cheese Salad

Salads | Oven

Before you start

Before cooking, prepare the chopped, sliced, grated, or otherwise prepped ingredients as listed below. Keep ingredients separate unless they share a labeled prep bowl.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Cinnamon and brown sugar

Bowl B - Chopped lettuces

Bowl C - Vinaigrette ingredients; blue cheese stays separate pending clarification

- [ ] 1/3 cup pecans sliced-lengthwise
- [ ] 1/2 teaspoon cinnamon [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 Tablespoon dark brown sugar [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1 1/2 teaspoons butter, melted
- [ ] 3 cups chopped butter or bibb lettuce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 cups chopped red leaf lettuce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 3 cups chopped iceberg lettuce [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 green onion, chopped
- [ ] 1/4 cup olive oil [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1/4 cup white wine vinegar [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1/4 teaspoon balsamic vinegar [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 teaspoons Dijon mustard [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 tablespoons sour cream [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 tablespoons honey [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 tablespoons chopped fresh basil [Bowl C]
- [ ] salt & freshly ground black pepper, to taste [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1/2 cup crumbled blue cheese

1. Prepare and cook

1. Preheat oven to 375 degrees F.

2. Slice 1/3 cup pecans lengthwise, cutting each half into at least three pieces.

3. Combine 1/2 tsp cinnamon and 1 tbsp dark brown sugar.

4. Toss the pecans with 1 1/2 tsp melted butter, then coat evenly with the cinnamon-sugar mixture.

5. Put the nuts on a parchment-lined baking sheet and bake for 5 to 8 minutes, until sugar is caramelized.

6. Remove the baking sheet from the oven and slide the pecans off of the parchment to cool.

7. Chop and rinse 3 cups each butter/Bibb, red leaf, and iceberg lettuce; drain well.

8. Chop 1 green onion.

9. Whisk 1/4 cup olive oil, 1/4 cup white wine vinegar, 1/4 tsp balsamic vinegar, 2 tsp Dijon, 2 tbsp sour cream, 2 tbsp honey, 1 tbsp chopped fresh basil, and salt and pepper to taste. The source also lists 1/2 cup crumbled blue cheese but does not say when to add it; see note.

10. Place the chopped lettuce into a serving bowl large enough to allow you to toss the salad.

11. Add the vinaigrette and toss thoroughly.

12. Sprinkle with the chopped onion.

13. Break the cooled pecan slices apart and sprinkle them over the salad.

14. Enjoy!

Notes

Saved as an Outback Steakhouse-style salad. Chill the bowl ahead if transporting; toss just before leaving. Ready-made candied pecans may replace the candied cinnamon pecans.

The source lists 1/2 cup crumbled blue cheese but omits it from the method. Confirm whether to blend it into the dressing or use it as a topping.